

Logic & Irreversible Acts

Civilian Prefinality: how to think in states, denies, and writes that cannot cheaply undo. This is the general subject under Gate's mouth.

Source: General subject pack (Gate-tied) - companion to docs 01, 03, 06, 11

One sentence

Logic for Gate is not debate club - it is: under uncertainty, the irreversible write must not complete.

Primitives

Proposition: A claim that is true or false in a context (fuse is LIVE; ticket is unspent).

Implication: If A then B. If fuse DEAD -> write must not complete.

Necessary vs sufficient: LIVE may be necessary for spend and still not sufficient without a matching ticket fingerprint.

Contradiction: Claiming Clear while reconstruction fails. Soft-yes under unknown is a contradiction with fail-closed.

Invariant: A law that must hold on every path (write_executed false on Gate clearance; CHARGE-only resurrect).

Fail-closed as default

Under missing proof, timeout, or broken link to authority: DENY / HOLD. Never invent LIVE because the dashboard felt friendly.

- Unknown != allow
- Retry on money-leave can duplicate an irreversible act - treat retries as dangerous until proven idempotent
- Admin flip is not CHARGE

States, not vibes

- Name the state: LIVE / DEAD / presented / consumed / halted.
- Name the transition: what event alone moves DEAD -> LIVE?
- Name the side effect: does this step leave money, bind policy, or only return a receipt?
- If you cannot name state + transition + side effect, you do not understand the act yet.

Irreversible vs reversible

- Reversible: edit a draft email, regenerate a PDF, restart a demo hop.
- Irreversible (or costly to reverse): wire out, peg out, bind coverage, delete with no backup, agent tool that spends.
- Gate sits on permission for the irreversible class. Diligence asks where can still completes without may.

Clear <=> reconstruct (logic form)

At the effectuation boundary: Clear if and only if the presented proof can be reconstructed AND the authority is LIVE. A GO sticker without reconstructability is not Clear - it is cosplay.

Practice drills

- Write each of the four laws as IF ... ELSE DENY.
- Take one payout path and list: states, who can say may, who executes the write, what stranger can open.
- Find one place in your own life where can != may (keys exist, permission missing).

What this is not

- Not symbolic logic homework for its own sake
- Not philosophy that never names a write
- Not soft ethics that replaces DENY with discussion